Sabeena Farooq, 45
Budgam, Jammu & Kashmir



What makes her a water warrior: Sabeena, a Pani Samiti member, defied patriarchal resistance to ensure clean drinking water for her village. Determined to inspire women, she brought five more women into the mission, working alongside the Sarpanch for the successful implementation of Har Ghar Jal under the Jal Jeevan Mission. She led the **installation of a filtration plant**, ensuring safe drinking water for all households. Engaging the community in monitoring water supply, she oversaw pipeline installation, repairs, and a new water storage tank. Through her persistence, water security became a reality, proving that grassroots leadership can transform villages drop by drop.



Asha Komati, 48
Shivani Khurd, Yavatmal, Maharashtra

What makes her a water warrior: Asha Komati turned water conservation into a community movement, mobilizing four villages to build 148 soak pits, advocate for water quality testing, and push for sanitation reforms. Noticing that her village had water but lacked cleanliness and sufficiency, she partnered with WaterAid and NIWCYD, training in water **budgeting and contamination control**. Her leadership spurred the Gram Panchayat to construct toilets and well-recharge structures, reducing health risks and groundwater depletion. Asha's work proves that water conservation is not just about quantity but quality, securing a cleaner, healthier future for her community.

Chandrika Kisan, 35
Gopalpali, Deogarh, Odisha



What makes her a water warrior: Chandrika Kisan, a farmer, tube-well mechanic, and community leader, has transformed Odisha's Deogarh district through grassroots water conservation. She began with awareness campaigns on sanitation and water hygiene but quickly moved to action—forming a **village water user committee** to oversee conservation efforts. Under her leadership, nine ponds and three check dams were built, replenishing groundwater and ensuring year-round water availability. Beyond infrastructure, she empowered women to take active roles in water governance, proving that conservation is both an environmental and social movement, shaping a sustainable future from the ground up.